

Topic Input – Social Media



THE LONDON SCHOOL
OF ECONOMICS AND
POLITICAL SCIENCE ■

What are the main issues/hot topics related to the topic of social media (e.g. privacy)? Take 5 minutes to brainstorm.



Discussion Question



1. What are the most popular social media platforms in your home country?
2. Has social media influenced communication styles in your country or culture?
3. How do you personally use social media in your academic or professional life?
4. In what ways has social media influenced your field of study or future career?
5. Do you think concerns about data privacy, misinformation, and online behaviour vary globally? Should there be universal regulations for social media platforms?
6. Should universities or employers monitor students' or employees' social media activity?
7. Overall, do you think social media contributes more to global understanding or to misinformation and division? Why?
8. What are the psychological effects of social media, and how can individuals maintain a healthy relationship with these platforms while staying connected?
9. What are the biggest challenges or risks associated with social media use today?
10. How do you envision the evolution of social media in the next decade?

Definitions are important in social science to ensure that everyone has the same understanding



For example, the statement “privacy is important” can have different interpretations and applications depending on how people define privacy.



Definition of Privacy	Interpretation of “Privacy is important”	Social Media Concern
Control over personal information	Users should choose what to share and with whom	Privacy settings, audience selection
Anonymity	Users should be unidentifiable or untraceable online	Desire for pseudonyms, no real-name policies, anonymous postings
Protection from surveillance	Users should be free from tracking by companies or governments	Data collection, targeted ads, surveillance
The right to be left alone	Users should be able to avoid harassment or unwanted attention	Comment moderation, private profiles

A definition should indicate:

- the general form/type of entity/phenomenon being identified
 - its main use/function
 - its purpose
 - its typical context
 - its main features
- 
- A decorative pattern at the bottom of the slide consisting of a grid of squares in various shades of gray, creating a pixelated or mosaic effect.

Privacy is a concept (FORM) that concerns the control individuals or groups have over access to their personal information and activities (FUNCTION) in order to protect autonomy, dignity, and freedom from unwanted intrusion (PURPOSE) within social, legal, and technological environments (CONTEXT); it involves principles such as consent, confidentiality, and data protection, and is shaped by cultural norms, legal frameworks, and digital technologies (FEATURES).

In pairs/threes, work together to write a similar definition for social media



Social Media is....



Language Points – to count or not to count?



Data (Singular or Plural?)

Data is a Latin plural with a singular *datum* so technically it is a plural noun. However, in practice, it can be treated as singular or plural.

*The data **were** analysed after they **were** collected.*

OR

*The data **was** analysed after it **was** collected.*

Language Points – to count or not to count?



Media (Singular or Plural?)

The word *media* is the Latin plural of *medium* (see below)

- *Radio is a more basic medium than television*
- *Radio and television were the two most innovative media in the twentieth century.*

Language Points – to count or not to count?



However, like data, *media* is often treated as a single noun.

Compare:

Social media, such as Facebook, Twitter and Instagram, ***have*** a huge influence on the behaviour and attitudes of young people today. (*plural – a number of mediums*)

Social media has a huge influence on the behaviour and attitudes of young people today. (*singular – the entity of social media as a whole*)

Watch the short talk and note down the main points the speaker makes



After listening...



- Compare with a partner or in a group of three and see if you have noted down the same points.
- In light of the points made in the video, look at one of the set of issues on the next page and discuss to what extent you feel they are a significant for you and your peers. What solutions, if any, do you think there might be to these problems?

Group A



1. Spending too much time on social media
2. Getting addicted to social media
3. The update syndrome
4. Neglecting family and responsibilities
5. Dependence on online friends

Group B



1. Managing social media time
2. Wasting time on social media
3. Reducing attention span
4. Lack of focus and productivity
5. The FOMO (Fear of Missing Out) Syndrome

Group C



1. Wasting time playing games
2. Seeking validation
3. Relationship issues due to social media
4. Infidelity on social media
5. Disturbing privacy issues

Group D



1. Falling for fake identities
2. Getting duped on social media
3. Health issues due to social media
4. Negative impact on academics
5. Dangers of cybercrime and bullying

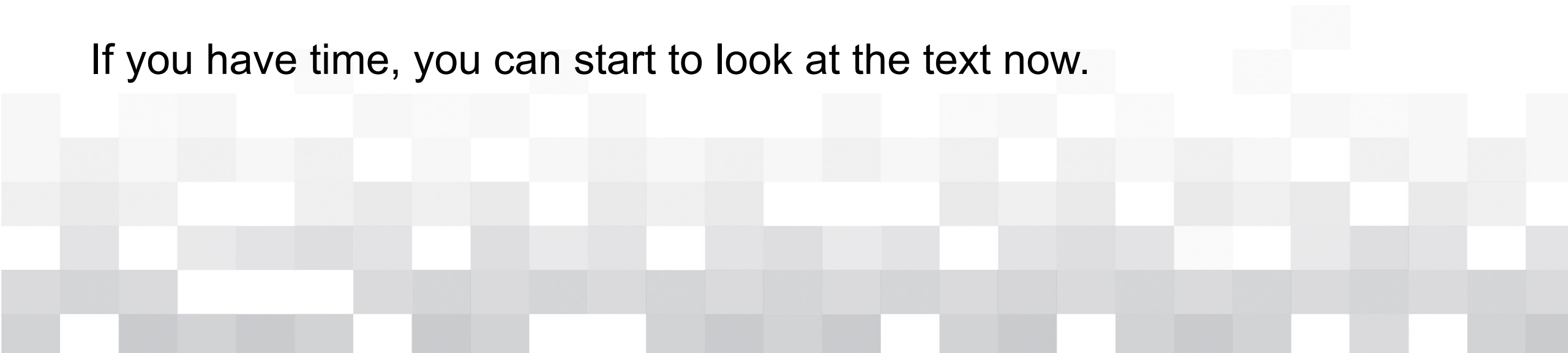
Extra Reading



In the Academic Interaction class on Thursday, you will be discussing a text about social media and well-being.

You can find the text on Moodle. Please read the text before the class on Thursday.

If you have time, you can start to look at the text now.

A decorative pattern of light gray and white squares, resembling a pixelated or mosaic effect, located at the bottom of the slide.